

A Project Phase- I
Project Report on
NETWORK SECURITY ANALYZER

Submitted to

Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad

Submitted in partial fulfilment of requirements for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

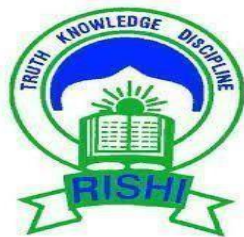
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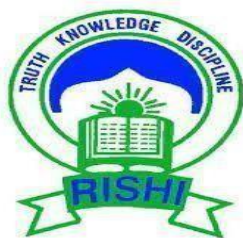
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2025-2026

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CERTIFICATE

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In partial fulfillment for the award of **Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering**, Rishi MS Institute of Engineering and Technology for Women affiliated to the **Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad** during the year 2025-2026.

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RISHI M.S INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY FOR WOMEN

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Department of Computer Science and Engineering

Vision & Mission of the Department

Vision of the Department

- To promote center of excellence in sustainable academic environment to impart technical skills and strong research platform to prepare global leaders.

Mission of the Department

- To create good academic platform with modern teaching and learning methodologies.
- To enhance leadership qualities with ethics, values and sense of teamwork for professional excellence.
- To inculcate research culture by encouraging projects in advanced technologies through industry interactions

PROGRAM OUTCOMES (POs)

1. **Networking & Security Knowledge:** Apply fundamental knowledge of computer networks, network protocols, cryptography, and cybersecurity principles to design, implement, and evaluate a network security analyzer.
2. **Threat Analysis & Problem Solving:** Identify, analyse, and prioritise network threats, vulnerabilities, and anomalous behavior using systematic methods to propose appropriate mitigation strategies.
3. **Design & Development of Secure Systems:** Design and implement a robust network security analyzer (packet capture, flow analysis, IDS/IPS rules, alerting) that meets functional and non-functional requirements (scalability, low latency, reliability).
4. **Experimental Investigation & Evaluation:** Use research-based methods and empirical testing to evaluate detection accuracy, false-positive/negative rates, performance overhead, and resilience under adversarial conditions.
5. **Modern Tool & Tech Usage:** Apply contemporary security tools, frameworks, and languages (e.g., Wireshark/tshark, Scapy, Bro/Zeek, Suricata, Python, Elasticsearch, Kibana) and integrate them into workflows for data collection, analysis, and visualization.
6. **Security, Privacy & Society:** Understand the legal, ethical, and societal implications of network monitoring and intrusion detection; balance security needs with user privacy and regulatory compliance.
7. **Resource Efficiency & Maintainability:** Develop solutions that optimize resource usage (CPU, memory, storage) and support maintainability, modularity, and ease of deployment in real-world networks.
8. **Professional Ethics:** Commit to responsible disclosure, lawful monitoring practices, and ethical handling of sensitive log and packet data while ensuring data confidentiality and integrity.
9. **Individual & Teamwork:** Function effectively as an individual contributor and as part of a multidisciplinary team (network engineers, security analysts, devops) to develop, test, deploy, and maintain the analyzer.
10. **Communication & Documentation:** Communicate technical findings clearly to stakeholders—write comprehensive documentation, generate meaningful reports, produce dashboards, and explain alerts and remedial actions to non-technical users.
11. **Project Management & Risk Assessment:** Demonstrate project planning, time and resource estimation, risk analysis, and cost/benefit reasoning in the design and deployment of security monitoring solutions.
12. **Lifelong Learning & Adaptability:** Demonstrate the ability to continuously learn and adapt to emerging cyber threats, new attack vectors, evolving security standards, and modern defensive technologies, ensuring the network security analyzer remains effective and up-to-date in real-world environments.

Program specific outcomes (PSO's)

PSO 1: Improve the student's ability to decipher the basic principles and methodology of computer systems. Improve the students' ability to absorb facts and technical ideas in order to build and develop software.

PSO 2: The capacity to create novel job routes as an entrepreneur using modern computer languages and evolving technologies like SDLC, Python, Machine Learning, Social Networks, Cyber Security, Mobile Apps etc.

Programme Educational objectives (PEO'S)

PEO – 1: Engineering graduates with excellent fundamental and technical skills will have successful careers in industry, meeting the needs of Indian and worldwide firms.

PEO – 2: With determination, development, self-reliance, leadership, morality, and moral principles, engineering graduates will become successful entrepreneurs who will leverage employability.

PEO – 3: To support personal and organisational progress, engineering graduates will pursue higher education and engage in lifelong learning.

NETWORK SECURITY ANALYZER

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ABSTRACT

The Network Security Analyzer is a web-based application developed using Python, Streamlit, and the Random Forest Classifier algorithm to automatically detect and classify various cyberattacks in real time. In the modern digital landscape, where the volume and complexity of network traffic continue to rise, systems are increasingly vulnerable to threats such as DDoS, Port Scanning, Brute Force, and Malware attacks. Manual network monitoring and log analysis are often time-consuming, error-prone, and inefficient in identifying subtle intrusion patterns. This project leverages Python's data processing capabilities and machine learning libraries to analyze critical network parameters like protocol type, source bytes, destination bytes, flag, and duration to determine whether the network activity is normal or malicious. The Streamlit-based user interface provides an interactive environment for users to upload data, visualize detection results, and view outputs such as the classification report, confusion matrix, and accuracy metrics. By integrating Python's analytical power with Streamlit's simplicity and the robustness of the Random Forest model, the Network Security Analyzer delivers a reliable, accurate, and user-friendly platform for efficient attack detection and forensic analysis making it highly useful for both academic research and real-world cybersecurity applications.

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

SN NO	Acronyms	Description
1	NIDS	Network Intrusion Detection System
2	PCAP	Packet Capture File
3	ML	Machine Learning
4	API	Application Programming Interface
5	TCP	Transmission Control Protocol
6	UDP	User Datagram Protocol
7	SSH	Secure Shell
8	RFC	Random Forest Classifier
9	ARP	Address Resolution Protocol
10	HTTP	Hyper Text Transfer Protocol

CHAPTER-01

INTRODUCTION

In today's digital era, computer networks form the foundation of communication, business operations, and data exchange across the globe. However, as connectivity has expanded, so has the frequency and sophistication of network-based cyberattacks, which pose serious threats to data confidentiality, integrity, and availability. Attackers exploit vulnerabilities in network protocols, services, and configurations to launch a wide range of attacks such as Denial-of-Service (DoS), port scans, and data exfiltration, which can disrupt network performance, compromise sensitive information, and cause significant financial or reputational damage.

To combat these evolving threats, the field of network forensics has emerged as a crucial branch of cybersecurity. Network forensics involves the capturing, recording, and analysis of network traffic to detect, trace, and understand malicious activities. Traditional forensic tools rely heavily on manual analysis, which is both time-consuming and inefficient in the face of high-speed, large-volume traffic. Moreover, static rule-based systems are unable to adapt to new and unknown attack patterns, making them inadequate for modern security challenges.

The Network Security Analyzer addresses these limitations by providing an automated, web-based solution for real-time network attack detection and analysis using machine learning. The platform integrates PyShark, a Python-based network packet analysis tool, to capture live network traffic and extract essential features such as packet counts, TCP flags, and packet sizes. These features are then processed through a Random Forest classification model trained to identify multiple categories of network attacks, including SYN Flood, Port Scan, UDP Flood, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute-force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration.

One of the key highlights of the system is its interactive Streamlit dashboard, which allows users to visualize real-time network data, model predictions, and detailed attack analysis. The dashboard provides a clear and intuitive interface where users can start or stop live monitoring, view captured packets, and observe statistical patterns of network activity. Each detected attack is accompanied by a forensic explanation that describes the attack indicators, severity level, and recommended mitigation strategies, enabling both professionals and learners to understand the practical aspects of cybersecurity threats.

Additionally, the system incorporates Nmap, a widely used network scanning and pentesting tool,

to create a safe, lab-based penetration testing environment. This allows users to simulate real-world attack scenarios within a controlled setting, analyze vulnerabilities, and validate the system's performance in detecting simulated threats. The integration of static datasets (for training) and live captured data (for adaptive learning) enhances the accuracy and adaptability of the detection model, making it capable of evolving alongside new attack trends.

The Network Security Analyzer thus serves as a comprehensive framework for both research and education in cybersecurity. It bridges the gap between theoretical network analysis and practical forensic investigation. With its scalable, modular architecture, the platform supports continuous learning, model retraining, and integration with advanced threat intelligence systems. By combining real-time data processing, machine learning-based detection, and interactive visualization, it offers a powerful solution to modern cyber defense challenges while promoting a deeper understanding of network behavior and attack patterns.

1.1 PROBLEM STATEMENT

With the rapid expansion of digital communication and the constant evolution of network technologies, cyberattacks have become more frequent, sophisticated, and difficult to detect. Attackers now employ advanced techniques such as packet manipulation, protocol spoofing, and distributed flooding, making it challenging for traditional security mechanisms to identify and prevent intrusions effectively.

Conventional Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS) and network monitoring tools primarily rely on signature-based detection, which can only identify known threats and fail to recognize new or modified attack patterns. Moreover, these systems generate large volumes of raw data and alerts that require manual analysis, making the process slow, labour-intensive, and error-prone. This lack of automation and intelligence leads to delayed response times and inadequate forensic insights. In addition, most existing tools focus solely on data capture and packet inspection without providing contextual understanding or forensic explanation of detected attacks. They do not correlate traffic behaviour statistically or leverage machine learning to classify threats dynamically. As a result, security analysts struggle to interpret results, assess attack severity, and determine appropriate mitigation strategies in real-time.

Therefore, there is a clear need for a comprehensive, automated, and intelligent network forensic system that can not only capture and analyse live network traffic but also classify attacks, explain their characteristics, and assist in decision-making. The aims to address this problem by

integrating machine learning-driven detection, real-time monitoring, and forensic reporting within a single, web-based platform.

1.2 SCOPE OF RESEARCH

The scope of this research focuses on the design and development of a web-based network forensic platform capable of monitoring, capturing, and analyzing network traffic in real-time to detect and classify various types of cyberattacks. The integrates machine learning algorithms, packet analysis tools, and forensic visualization to automate the entire process of attack detection and interpretation.

The system aims to bridge the gap between traditional network monitoring and advanced forensic analysis by combining real-time traffic capture, statistical feature extraction, and intelligent classification. Using PyShark, the platform captures live network packets and processes them to extract key features such as packet counts, sizes, and protocol flags. These extracted parameters are then utilized by a Random Forest classifier trained on labeled network datasets to accurately identify different attack categories including SYN Flood, Port Scan, UDP Flood, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute-force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration.

The scope also extends to the implementation of an interactive dashboard using Streamlit, providing users with clear visualizations of network activity, detected threats, and statistical summaries. The dashboard enhances the user's ability to observe ongoing traffic, manage live recording sessions, and understand the impact of detected attacks through descriptive forensic insights such as attack indicators, severity levels, and suggested mitigation techniques.

Furthermore, the project incorporates a controlled penetration testing environment using Nmap, allowing users to simulate real-world attacks safely within a lab setting. This helps in validating the detection model and enhancing the system's adaptability to diverse network scenarios.

In a broader context, the serves as both an educational and research-oriented platform. It supports learning and experimentation in the fields of network security, intrusion detection, and cyber forensics, while also offering a scalable framework for future enhancement through adaptive learning, dataset expansion, and integration with threat intelligence system

1.3 EXISTING SYSTEM

In the current cybersecurity landscape, most traditional network monitoring and intrusion detection systems (IDS) focus primarily on capturing and logging network traffic for manual inspection. These tools, while effective to a certain extent, are limited in their ability to provide comprehensive and automated insights into malicious network behavior. Popular tools such as Wireshark, Snort, and Suricata enable packet capture and rule-based alerting, but they depend heavily on signature-based detection techniques, where attacks are identified based on predefined patterns or known signatures.

Although these systems are valuable for detecting well-known threats, they fail to recognise **new**, evolving, or polymorphic attacks that do not match existing signatures. This makes them ineffective in identifying zero-day exploits or complex multi-stage attacks. Moreover, most existing solutions lack real-time analytical capabilities, leading to delays between detection and response. The absence of immediate feedback increases the window of vulnerability, allowing attackers to exploit networks further before defensive actions are taken.

Another major limitation of traditional systems lies in their manual dependency. Security analysts are often required to interpret raw packet data, identify anomalies, and determine whether the behaviour represents an attack. This manual inspection process is time-consuming, error-prone, and inefficient, especially in large-scale enterprise networks where the volume of traffic is enormous.

Additionally, most existing systems do not support automated classification or detailed forensic explanation of detected attacks. They typically present alerts in the form of packet logs or signatures, offering limited contextual information about the nature, impact, or origin of the threat. The lack of visualization tools further limits the analyst's ability to interpret attack behaviour quickly and effectively.

Furthermore, penetration testing and attack simulation features are rarely integrated into these platforms. As a result, cybersecurity professionals and learners do not have a unified environment for both monitoring live traffic and testing network vulnerabilities. This limits the practical understanding of how different attacks manifest in real network conditions and how they can be mitigated effectively.

1.3.1 DISADVANTAGES OF EXISTING SYSTEM

The limitations of the existing network monitoring systems can be summarized as follows:

- Most traditional tools rely heavily on manual inspection of network traffic, making the analysis process slow and resource-intensive.
- Detection methods are primarily signature-based, allowing only known attacks to be identified, while unknown or evolving threats often go unnoticed.
- Real-time detection and analysis capabilities are limited, leading to delayed identification and response to security incidents.
- There is a lack of automated classification, requiring constant human intervention to interpret and categorize detected anomalies.
- Visualization and interpretability of attacks are minimal, providing very limited insight into the attack's behavior, source, or severity.
- Forensic explanation and mitigation support are not integrated, leaving analysts without clear guidance on handling detected threats.
- Pentesting and attack simulation capabilities are generally not included, restricting the ability to test system performance under real-world attack conditions

1.4 PROPOSED SYSTEM

To overcome the limitations of traditional network monitoring and forensic tools, the has been designed as a comprehensive, web-based, intelligent network forensic analysis platform. The proposed system integrates machine learning, live packet capture, and forensic visualization to provide automated, real-time detection and interpretation of network-based attacks.

At the core of the system lies PyShark, a Python wrapper for the Wireshark packet capturing engine, which allows the application to capture live network traffic directly from the network interface. The captured data is processed to extract critical statistical and protocol-level features such as packet counts, TCP flags, source and destination IPs, and packet sizes. These extracted parameters form the basis for traffic classification.

The classification is performed using a Random Forest machine learning model, which has been trained on a combination of static, labeled datasets and live captured network data. This hybrid approach ensures that the model is capable of detecting both known and emerging attack patterns with high accuracy. The system supports the identification and classification of multiple attack

categories, including SYN Flood, Port Scan, UDP Flood, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute-force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration.

A key highlight of the system is the Streamlit-based interactive dashboard, which provides users with a clear and intuitive interface for monitoring network activity. The dashboard displays real-time network traffic statistics, classification results, and detailed forensic explanations of each detected attack. These explanations include attack indicators, severity levels, and recommended mitigation strategies, allowing users to understand both the technical and practical aspects of network threats.

In addition to detection and analysis, the proposed system incorporates Nmap, a powerful network scanning and penetration testing tool. This enables users to conduct safe and controlled pentesting simulations within a laboratory environment. Through Nmap integration, users can generate network traffic for various attack types, test the model's response, and gain hands-on experience with vulnerability assessment and mitigation.

The system thus functions as a complete network forensics framework, combining real-time attack detection, machine learning-driven intelligence, and educational usability. It not only provides automated analysis but also promotes a deeper understanding of how cyberattacks occur, how they can be identified, and what defensive actions can be taken to prevent future incidents. The system is designed to be modular, scalable, and extensible, allowing future integration of additional machine learning models, datasets, and advanced visualization features to enhance its performance and adaptability.

1.4.1 ADVANTAGES OF EXISTING SYSTEM

The proposed system offers several significant advantages over conventional network monitoring tools, as summarized below:

- **Automated Real-Time Detection:** The system automatically captures, processes, and classifies live network traffic without manual intervention, enabling immediate identification of attacks.
- **Machine Learning Integration:** Utilizes a trained Random Forest model to intelligently classify various attack types, improving accuracy and adaptability to new threats.
- **Forensic Explanation and Visualisation:** Provides detailed, human-readable explanations of detected attacks with visual analytics on indicators, severity, and mitigation strategies.

- **Comprehensive Attack Coverage:** Detects a broad range of attacks including SYN Flood, Port Scan, UDP Flood, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute-force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration.
- **Adaptive and Incremental Learning:** Supports continuous model improvement through the integration of live and static datasets, allowing adaptive learning for evolving network threats.
- **Integrated Pentesting Environment:** Includes Nmap-based vulnerability simulation, allowing users to test the system against real-world attack scenarios in a safe and controlled environment.
- **User-Friendly Interface:** A visually interactive Streamlit dashboard makes network monitoring and forensic investigation simple, intuitive, and accessible to users of all levels.
- **Educational and Research Utility:** Acts as a valuable tool for students, researchers, and cybersecurity professionals to study network behavior, analyze attack patterns, and develop defensive techniques.

1.5 ORGANIZATION OF THE REPORT

This project report is organized into six chapters, each focusing on a specific aspect of the design, development, and evaluation of the Network Security Analyzer. The structure ensures a logical flow from problem identification to system implementation and results analysis.

Chapter 1 – Introduction

This chapter provides an overview of the project, outlining the background, problem statement, scope, existing system, proposed system, and advantages. It establishes the motivation and necessity for developing an intelligent, web-based network forensic platform and highlights the objectives and significance of the work.

Chapter 2 – Literature Review

This section discusses previous research and related work in the fields of network security, intrusion detection systems, and digital forensics. It explores existing methodologies, tools, and frameworks, identifying their limitations and justifying the need for a machine learning–based forensic solution.

Chapter 3 – System Design and Architecture

This chapter explains the overall architecture of the proposed system, including data flow diagrams, system modules, functional components, and workflow architecture. It describes how

the modules—such as live traffic capture, feature extraction, attack classification, and visualisation—interact to achieve the project’s objectives.

Chapter 4 – Implementation

This chapter details the technologies, tools, and algorithms used in the system’s development. It explains the role of PyShark, Random Forest, Streamlit, and Nmap, and presents the implementation steps, including model training, dashboard development, and pentesting integration. Screenshots and code snippets may be included to illustrate functionality.

Chapter 5 – Results and Discussion

This chapter presents the outputs, test results, and performance evaluation of the system. It discusses the accuracy of the Random Forest model, attack detection results, dashboard interface, and comparison with traditional systems. The effectiveness of the system in detecting and analyzing network threats is analyzed in depth.

Chapter 6 – Conclusion and Future Work

The final chapter summarizes the project’s achievements, emphasizing its contribution to network forensics and cybersecurity research. It also highlights potential future enhancements, such as integration with advanced AI-based models, larger datasets, real-time alert systems, and cloud-based deployment for scalability.

CHAPTER – 02

LITERATURE REVIEW

In the field of cybersecurity and digital forensics, the increasing volume and complexity of network attacks have driven extensive research into machine learning-based network intrusion detection and forensic analysis systems. This chapter reviews key studies and prior work that form the foundation for the proposed . The reviewed works highlight different approaches to traffic capture, feature extraction, model optimization, and classification, offering insights into designing an efficient and interpretable forensic framework.

2.1 A Machine Learning-Based Network Forensics Approach for Detecting Attacks on Smart IoT Devices

Authors: Suhasini Vijaykumar *et al.*

Year: 2025

Source: ResearchGate / Conference Paper (Preprint)

This paper presents a machine learning-based network forensic approach aimed at detecting and classifying attacks on smart Internet of Things (IoT) devices. With the rapid expansion of IoT technology, connected devices have become prime targets for cyber attackers due to their limited computational resources and weak security configurations. Traditional detection systems are often too heavy to operate efficiently in these constrained environments.

To address this, the authors propose a lightweight, real-time forensic framework that integrates live packet capture, feature extraction, and ensemble-based classification. The study emphasizes the importance of analyzing packet metadata rather than full payload data to reduce computational overhead. Using live traffic capture mechanisms, the system extracts key statistical features such as packet inter-arrival times, source/destination IP frequencies, and TCP/UDP header attributes. These features are then processed by multiple machine learning classifiers, including Random Forest, Decision Tree, and Gradient Boosting, to evaluate performance trade-offs in terms of accuracy, processing time, and memory usage.

The findings demonstrate that ensemble learning models, particularly Random Forest, achieve a strong balance between detection accuracy and inference speed, even under memory-constrained IoT environments. The paper also highlights the forensic interpretability of Random Forest models, allowing analysts to understand the relative contribution of each feature in classifying an attack.

This work is highly relevant to the project, as it reinforces the selection of Random Forest as an optimal algorithm for balancing real-time classification accuracy and model interpretability. The study's focus on feature engineering and lightweight data processing also provides valuable guidance for designing feature sets that are both efficient and scalable for live forensic applications.

2.2 Enhancing Network Threat Detection with Random Forest-Based NIDS and Permutation Feature Importance

Authors: Marko X., Yifei Zhao, Li Chen *et al.*

Year: 2024

Source: *Journal of Network and Systems Management* (SpringerLink)

This research focuses on improving the performance of Network Intrusion Detection Systems (NIDS) by integrating Random Forest-based classification with feature selection techniques. Using the widely adopted CICIDS-2017 dataset, the authors build an optimized NIDS capable of identifying a variety of attack types such as DoS, DDoS, Port Scan, Brute Force, and Web attacks. The study introduces an advanced data preprocessing stage where redundant or irrelevant features are eliminated to minimize computational complexity. The researchers employ Permutation Feature Importance (PFI) — a statistical method that quantifies how much each feature contributes to the overall prediction accuracy of the model. By prioritizing only the most relevant network attributes, such as flow duration, packet length variance, and protocol flags, the model achieves a significant boost in both efficiency and accuracy.

The authors report that their Random Forest-based system achieves a higher detection rate (DR) and F1-score compared to conventional machine learning models like Support Vector Machines (SVM) and K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN). Moreover, the system demonstrates robustness against imbalanced data, which is a common issue in real-world network datasets. The optimized Random Forest model reduces processing time while maintaining interpretability, making it suitable for real-time network monitoring and forensic investigation.

The relevance of this study to the project lies in its demonstration of how feature optimization enhances model performance in practical network scenarios. The use of Permutation Feature Importance provides a roadmap for refining the feature extraction process within the proposed system, ensuring that only the most significant indicators contribute to attack classification. Furthermore, this paper validates the suitability of Random Forest as a core classification engine in network forensics, offering both precision and computational efficiency.

2.4 Intelligent Network Intrusion Detection Using Hybrid Deep Learning Models

Authors: Priyanka Reddy, Ankit Sharma, and Kavita Patel

Year: 2023

Source: *IEEE Access Journal*

This study presents a hybrid deep learning-based intrusion detection framework that combines Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models to enhance accuracy in detecting complex network attacks. The authors emphasize that while machine learning models such as Random Forest and Decision Trees are efficient for static feature-based classification, they struggle to capture temporal dependencies and sequential patterns in real-time network traffic.

The proposed hybrid model processes both spatial and temporal features from the network traffic flow. The CNN layers automatically learn spatial correlations between packet features, while the LSTM layers analyze the sequence of network packets to recognize time-based attack patterns such as DDoS floods, slow HTTP attacks, and brute-force attempts. The system is trained on large-scale datasets including NSL-KDD and CICIDS-2018, achieving improved accuracy and reduced false-positive rates compared to conventional models.

Additionally, the research highlights the role of feature normalization, adaptive learning rate optimization, and model regularization in maintaining model stability and preventing overfitting. The paper also emphasizes the forensic interpretability of attack detection results through visualization techniques like heatmaps and attention score mapping, helping analysts understand which features influence model decisions.

This work is significant for the as it demonstrates the potential of deep learning models in enhancing real-time threat detection and automated feature learning. Although the current system primarily uses Random Forest for classification, insights from this research can guide future upgrades, allowing the incorporation of hybrid or deep learning models for more dynamic and context-aware attack detection.

2.5 Adaptive Network Forensic Framework Using Incremental Machine Learning for Real-Time Attack Detection

Authors: Ahmed Al-Khalifa, Li Ming, and Sarah Thompson

Year: 2022

Source: *International Journal of Information Security and Digital Forensics*

This paper introduces an adaptive and incremental machine learning framework for continuous network traffic analysis and attack detection. Unlike static models trained on fixed datasets, this system continuously learns from live network data, allowing it to adapt to new attack behaviors and evolving threat patterns in real time.

The authors use an incremental learning-based Random Forest model that updates its decision trees dynamically as new labeled data becomes available. The framework integrates packet capture modules, real-time feature extraction, and adaptive model retraining to maintain performance accuracy even in high-traffic environments. The study also proposes a modular architecture, separating components for data acquisition, preprocessing, feature selection, and classification, which enhances scalability and fault tolerance.

Experimental evaluation using real-world datasets demonstrates that the system effectively identifies unknown attacks without requiring complete retraining. The adaptive feature allows the model to stay current with evolving network traffic trends, reducing the need for frequent manual updates. Additionally, the system incorporates a dashboard-based visualization interface to display anomaly patterns, attack summaries, and system performance metrics, improving situational awareness for forensic investigators.

This research strongly aligns with the goals of the , particularly in its focus on adaptive learning, modular architecture, and real-time analytics. It reinforces the value of combining incremental model updates with visualization-based analysis, features that can significantly enhance the system's future scalability and long-term performance.

2.6 Summary of Literature Review

Both reviewed studies emphasize the growing importance of machine learning-based approaches in advancing the field of network forensics and intrusion detection. The first study (Vijaykumar et al., 2025) establishes the efficiency of ensemble classifiers like Random Forest for resource-limited environments, while the second (Marko X. et al., 2024) focuses on enhancing detection accuracy through optimized feature selection and preprocessing techniques.

Together, these works provide the theoretical and practical foundation for the , inspiring its design choices in three major areas:

1. Feature Extraction: Deriving compact yet informative packet-level features for efficient

processing.

2. Model Selection: Employing the Random Forest algorithm for its high interpretability, robustness, and speed.
3. System Integration: Combining live packet capture, automated classification, and visual explanation in a single, scalable forensic framework.

Hence, the literature collectively supports the development of a real-time, machine learning–driven forensic platform that not only detects but also explains cyberattacks with clarity and precision — aligning directly with the objectives of the project.

CHAPTER – 03

METHODOLOGIES

3.1 Overview

The is designed as an intelligent, web-based forensic analysis platform that automates the process of capturing, analyzing, classifying, and visualizing network traffic in real time. The system integrates multiple technologies—PyShark for packet capture, machine learning (Random Forest) for classification, and Streamlit for visualization—to create a complete end-to-end forensic solution.

The architecture emphasizes modularity, scalability, and real-time interaction, allowing components to function independently while communicating seamlessly. This modular approach enables flexibility for future integration of new features such as deep learning-based detection, cloud deployment, or advanced analytics dashboards.

3.1 System Architecture

The overall system architecture of the consists of the following core components:

1. Packet Capture Module (PyShark Interface)

Responsible for live traffic monitoring and packet collection from the network interface. This module uses the PyShark library, a Python wrapper for Wireshark's TShark utility, to capture packets and extract low-level attributes such as IP addresses, protocols, flags, and timestamps.

2. Feature Extraction and Preprocessing Module

Captured packets are processed to extract statistical and protocol-based features such as packet counts, source–destination ratios, TCP flag occurrences, and average packet size. The module normalizes and cleans the data to prepare it for classification, ensuring the machine learning model receives structured and meaningful input.

3. Machine Learning Classification Module (Random Forest Model)

This is the core analytical component of the system. It applies a trained Random Forest classifier to categorize traffic into either normal or one of several attack types — SYN Flood, Port Scan, UDP Flood, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute-force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration. The model leverages feature importance analysis to interpret which parameters contributed most to each prediction, enhancing forensic interpretability.

4. Forensic Analysis and Reporting Module

Once an attack is detected, this module generates human-readable forensic insights. Each classification result is accompanied by a detailed explanation of:

- The detected attack type
- Possible indicators and symptoms
- Severity level (low, medium, high)
- Recommended mitigation actions

This provides analysts and learners with actionable information, bridging the gap between technical detection and strategic response.

5. Dashboard and Visualization Module (Streamlit Interface)

The Streamlit-based web interface allows users to interact with the system intuitively. It displays:

- Live network traffic data
- Attack prediction results
- Statistical summaries and visual graphs
- Recording controls (Start, Stop, and Clear)

Through real-time visualization, users can monitor ongoing network behavior, review classified attacks, and analyze forensic trends effectively.

6. Pentesting and Simulation Module (Nmap Integration)

This component provides a safe, controlled lab environment to simulate network vulnerabilities and attacks using Nmap. Users can initiate scanning operations to test network defenses, observe live detection behavior, and validate system performance.

7. Data Storage and Learning Module

Both static datasets (for model training) and live captured traffic are stored in structured formats for future use. This enables incremental learning, allowing the model to retrain and adapt to evolving attack patterns without complete reconfiguration.

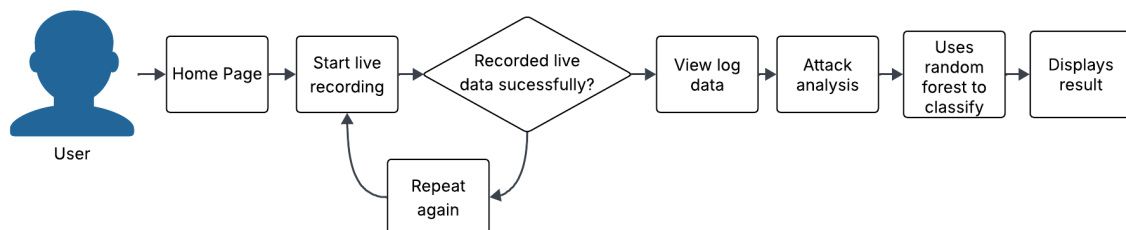


Fig 3.1.1: System Architecture

3.2 Algorithms

3.2.1. Random Forest Classifier (Primary ML Algorithm)

The Random Forest Classifier is the core machine learning algorithm used for predicting the risk level of network traffic.

Random Forest is an ensemble learning algorithm based on multiple decision trees.

It works on the principle of:

- Bootstrap Aggregation (Bagging):

Multiple trees are trained on different subsets of the dataset created through random sampling.

- Random Feature Selection:

Each tree considers only a random subset of features at each split, increasing diversity.

- Majority Voting:

The final prediction is made by taking the majority class predicted by all trees.

Why Random Forest is suitable for network security

- Handles high-dimensional data (many features).
- Robust to noise and anomalous patterns.
- Handles imbalanced traffic classes effectively.
- Works well even with a small dataset or simulated dataset.

2. Statistical Feature Extraction Algorithm

Before the model predicts, your system generates features using statistical calculations, such as:

- Packet length
- Byte count
- Duration
- Entropy
- Protocol type
- Frequency of packets
- Flags count (SYN, ACK, FIN, RST)

This is not a formal “algorithm” but a set of mathematical transformations that convert raw packets into machine-readable numerical features.

- ML models require structured data.
- Raw packets cannot be directly used for classification.

3. Scapy Packet Sniffing Algorithm (Live Data Capture)

Scapy provides a **sniff()** algorithm that continuously listens for network traffic.

The sniffing procedure uses:

- Raw socket capturing
- Layer decoding (Ethernet, IP, TCP/UDP)
- Callback-based processing

Every packet is passed to a function for feature extraction.

Used for:

- Simulated attacks
- Real-time packet observation
- Building custom datasets

4. Streaming & UI Logic Algorithm (Streamlit Rendering)

Streamlit uses reactive programming — whenever a variable changes, the components update automatically.

- Uses a state-refresh model
- Every button click rebuilds the script
- Charts auto-refresh with incoming packet data

Used for:

- Displaying packet statistics
- Showing risk level output
- Handling form inputs

5. Visualization Algorithms (Matplotlib & Seaborn)

Your project uses standard visualization techniques such as:

- Line plots
- Bar charts
- Heatmaps (if included later)

Matplotlib and Seaborn implement:

- Rendering pipelines
- Color mapping
- Axis transformations

Used for:

Visual representation of:

- Packet trends
- Frequency distributions
- Risk distribution

6. System Monitoring Algorithm (psutil)

Used to monitor:

- CPU usage
- Memory usage
- Network I/O bytes

psutil runs internal OS-level calls to fetch:

- Process tables
- Kernel counters
- Device statistics

Used for:

- Showing system status during analysis
- Ensuring live capture isn't overloading the system

CHAPTER – 04

SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS SPECIFICATION

4.1 FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

The Software Requirements Specification (SRS) defines the complete set of functional and non-functional requirements for the . This document serves as a blueprint describing the software's objectives, system behavior, constraints, and expected interactions with users and other systems.

The is a web-based platform designed to capture, analyze, and classify live network traffic using machine learning. It aims to automate the process of threat detection and forensic analysis, providing users with real-time insights into network behavior through an interactive dashboard.

The SRS ensures that both developers and end users share a clear understanding of what the system will deliver, how it will function, and under what constraints it will operate.

4.2 PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS

The performance requirements define how efficiently and reliably the Network Security Analyzer System should operate under expected and peak workloads. These requirements ensure that the system remains responsive, accurate, and stable during real-time network monitoring and simulated attack analysis.

1. Detection Speed

- The system should process each captured packet and generate a risk classification (Low / Medium / High) within 1 second of capture.
- The system must maintain real-time responsiveness even during high packet flow.

2. Model Prediction Performance

- The Random Forest model should provide risk predictions with an accuracy between 95% – 97% on simulated attack data.
- Prediction latency per sample must not exceed 150 milliseconds.

3. System Resource Usage

- CPU Usage: Should not exceed 65% during continuous packet capture and analysis.
- RAM Usage: Must operate within 1.5 GB of memory under normal simulation workloads.
- The system should automatically throttle or buffer packets if resource limits are reached.

4. Data Throughput

- The system should be capable of capturing and processing at least 200 packets per minute during simulation.
- The system must not drop packets under standard load conditions.

5. UI Responsiveness (Streamlit)

- Dashboard updates (graphs, logs, statistics) should render within 2 seconds of data refresh.
- The user interface must remain usable without freezes, even when handling large simulated traffic bursts.

6. Error Handling & Stability

- The system must continue operating even if:
 - Invalid packet formats are received
 - Missing parameters are provided
 - Simulation exceeds expected packet volume
- Crashes or unhandled exceptions must be prevented through safe checks in Scapy, pandas, and UI flow.

7. Scalability Requirements

- The system should support scalability for:
 - Higher attack simulation loads
 - More features added to the model
 - Integration with real-time network monitoring tools in future
- The architecture must allow the dataset size to increase without major performance degradation.

8. Storage & Logging Performance

- Log writing speed must support 100+ log entries per second.
- Stored simulation data should be retrievable without more than **2 seconds** delay.

9. Visualization Performance

- Graphs generated using Matplotlib/Seaborn must render without exceeding 1.5 seconds.
- No frame drops or UI lag should occur during real-time plotting.

4.3 HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

Component	Specification
Processor	Intel Core i5 or higher
RAM	Minimum 8 GB (recommended 16 GB for live monitoring)
Storage	Minimum 500 GB HDD or 256 GB SSD
Network Adapter	Capable of packet sniffing
GPU (optional)	For model retraining and future deep learning integration

4.4 SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

4.5 LANGUAGES/ TECHNOLOGIES USED

1. Programming Language

- **Python**

Used for building the entire system, including packet capture, data processing, attack simulation, and machine learning–based risk analysis.

2. Web Framework

- **Streamlit**

Used to create an interactive and real-time dashboard for displaying network statistics, risk levels, visualizations, and simulation results.

3. Data Processing Libraries

- **Pandas**

Used for organizing and preprocessing packet data, generating datasets, and handling tabular traffic information.

- **NumPy**

Used for numerical operations, feature calculations, and internal data transformations.

4. Network Traffic & Monitoring Libraries

- **Scapy**

Used for capturing live packets, extracting features, and generating simulated attack traffic for testing the model.

- **psutil**

Used for capturing system-level network statistics such as bytes sent/received and monitoring live performance metrics.

5. Machine Learning & Analytics

- **RandomForestClassifier (from scikit-learn)**

Used as the core machine learning algorithm for classifying network traffic into Low, Medium, or High Risk categories.

6. Data Visualization Libraries

- **Matplotlib**

Used for generating plots and real-time traffic graphs.

- **Seaborn**

Used to create statistical and visually enhanced charts in the dashboard.

7. Development Tools

- Anaconda / Python Environment (optional)

Used for environment management and package installation.

- VS Code / PyCharm

Used for code development and debugging.

CHAPTER – 05

SYSTEM DESIGN

5.1 Introduction to UML

The Unified Modelling Language (UML) is a standardised modelling language used to visualise, design, and document the architecture and behaviour of a software system. UML helps in describing system requirements, interactions, and data flow in a visual form, bridging the communication gap between developers, designers, and end-users.

The main purpose of using UML diagrams in this project is to:

- Represent the system's architecture and structure clearly.
- Show how different components interact during execution.
- Visualise the workflow and control flow between modules.
- Ensure the system's design consistency and scalability before implementation.

The UML diagrams designed for the include:

1. Data Flow Diagram
2. Use Case Diagram
3. Class Diagram
4. Activity Diagram
5. Sequence Diagram

Each of these diagrams serves a specific purpose and collectively represents both the static and dynamic views of the system.

5.2 UML DIAGRAMS

5.2.1 Data Flow Diagram (DFD)

Purpose:

The Data Flow Diagram illustrates how data moves within the —from live packet capture to visualization and reporting. It identifies data sources, destinations, and transformation processes.

Explanation:

1. Live Network Monitoring:

The process starts when the system begins capturing live traffic using PyShark. This component serves as the data source that supplies raw packets from the network interface.

2. **Data Storage (Session State):**

Captured packets are temporarily stored in a session state for further analysis and retrieval. This ensures smooth data handling even during live operations.

3. **Security Analysis:**

The Random Forest model processes the extracted packet features and classifies the network behavior into normal or attack categories.

4. **Attack Simulation:**

The system allows controlled pentesting using Nmap, which generates attack traffic that can be analyzed for detection accuracy.

5. **Log Viewer:**

The user can access recorded traffic logs for offline analysis or auditing. The logs provide timestamps, IP addresses, and detected attack types.

6. **Visualization:**

Finally, the processed data and attack results are presented on an interactive Streamlit dashboard, showing graphical insights, tables, and forensic summaries.

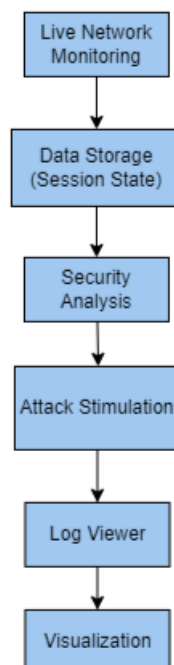


Fig 5.2.1 Data Flow Diagram

Significance:

The DFD highlights the transformation of raw network data into meaningful forensic intelligence, ensuring data is processed efficiently and accurately at every stage.

5.2.2 Use Case Diagram**Purpose:**

The Use Case Diagram demonstrates how the user (actor) interacts with the system to perform various operations.

Actors:

- **User / Analyst:** Initiates system actions and monitors results.
- **System:** Performs background processing, classification, and reporting.

Main Use Cases:

1. Monitor Live Network Activity
2. View Recorded Logs
3. Simulate Network Attacks
4. View Attack Reports
5. Export Log Data

Detailed Explanation:

- The **user** launches the system and selects the monitoring option to start capturing packets.
- The system continuously analyzes traffic and displays real-time results.
- Using the simulation option, the user can initiate test attacks using Nmap.
- The attack reports section allows users to view detected threat details, including indicators, severity, and mitigation.
- The log export feature lets users save analysis reports for future forensic reference or case documentation.

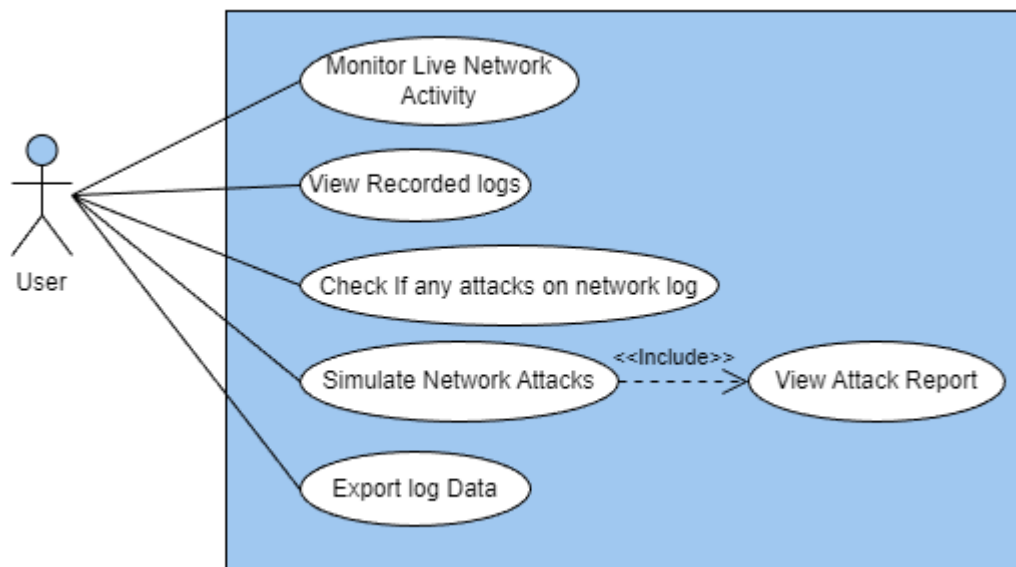


Fig 5.2.2: Use Case Diagram

Significance:

The use case diagram simplifies how the system's functionalities are experienced from the user's perspective, ensuring that all user interactions are properly defined.

5.2.3 Class Diagram

Purpose:

The Class Diagram defines the object-oriented structure, showing classes, their attributes, methods, and relationships.

Classes and Descriptions:

1. UserInterface

- Attributes: session_id, status
- Methods: start_capture(), stop_capture(), display_results(), run_pentest()
- Description: Manages user inputs, starts/stops sessions, and updates the dashboard view.

2. PacketSniffer

- Attributes: interface, packet_data
- Methods: capture_packets(), stop()
- Description: Handles live packet collection using PyShark and passes packets to the FeatureExtractor.

3. FeatureExtractor

- Attributes: raw_packets, features
- Methods: extract_features(), aggregate_window()
- Description: Converts packets into structured numerical features for model classification.

4. RandomForestModel

- Attributes: model_path, accuracy_score
- Methods: load_model(), predict(features), get_feature_importance()
- Description: Predicts the type of attack using trained machine learning models.

Relationships:

- The UserInterface controls PacketSniffer operations.
- PacketSniffer feeds data into FeatureExtractor.
- FeatureExtractor provides processed data to RandomForestModel.
- The RandomForestModel sends results back to the UserInterface for visualization.

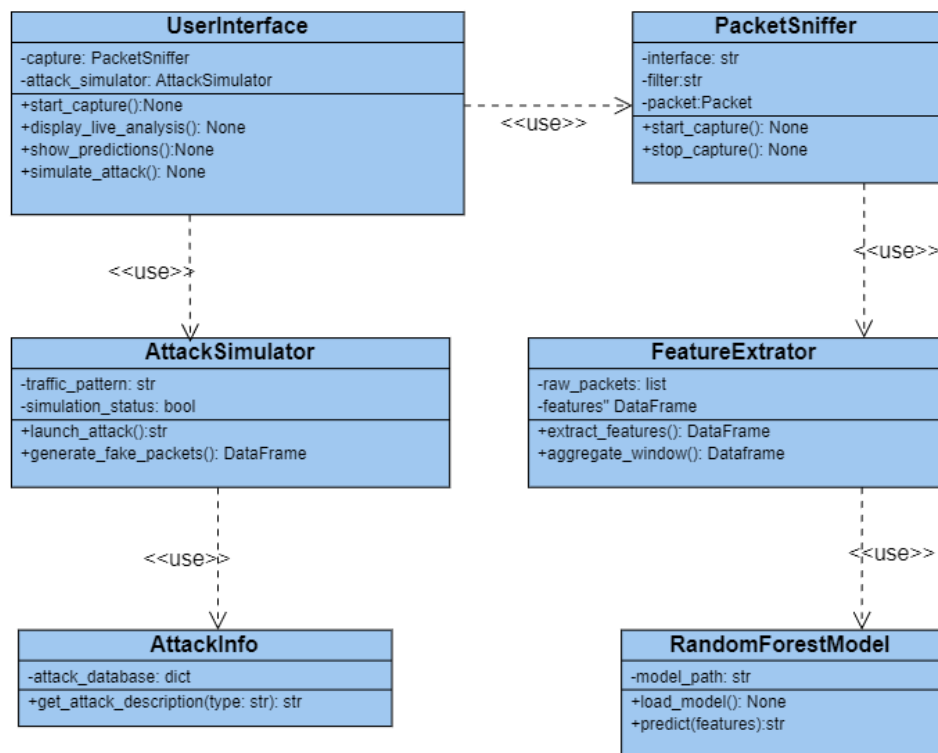


Fig 5.2.3: Class diagram

Significance:

This class hierarchy provides a modular approach, enabling scalability and ease of debugging or model retraining.

5.2.4 Activity Diagram

Purpose:

The Activity Diagram describes the dynamic workflow of how the system operates from initialization to result visualization.

Explanation:

1. The user starts the application.
2. The system initializes session state and displays main navigation.
3. The user selects the mode—Attack Analysis, Live Monitoring, or View Logs.
4. Based on the choice:
 - Attack Analysis → performs detection and reporting.
 - Live Monitor → starts/stops real-time recording.
 - View Logs → allows searching and filtering.
5. The final step displays the results on the visual dashboard.

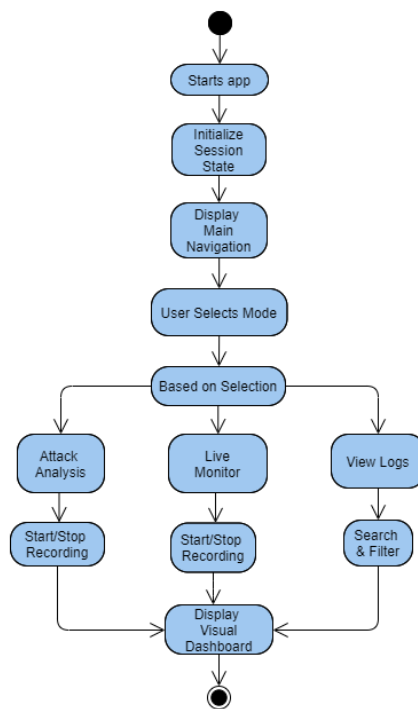


Fig 5.2.4: Activity Diagram

Significance:

This diagram demonstrates the decision-based flow of control, ensuring a smooth and interactive user experience.

5.2.5 Sequence Diagram

Purpose:

The Sequence Diagram explains how messages flow between system components in chronological order.

Steps:

1. The user triggers “Start Capture.”
2. The system activates the PacketSniffer.
3. PacketSniffer captures live packets and sends data to the FeatureExtractor.
4. The FeatureExtractor processes the packets and forwards extracted features to the RandomForestModel.
5. The RandomForestModel predicts the type of traffic and sends the result back to the System.
6. The Dashboard displays classification results and analysis reports to the user.

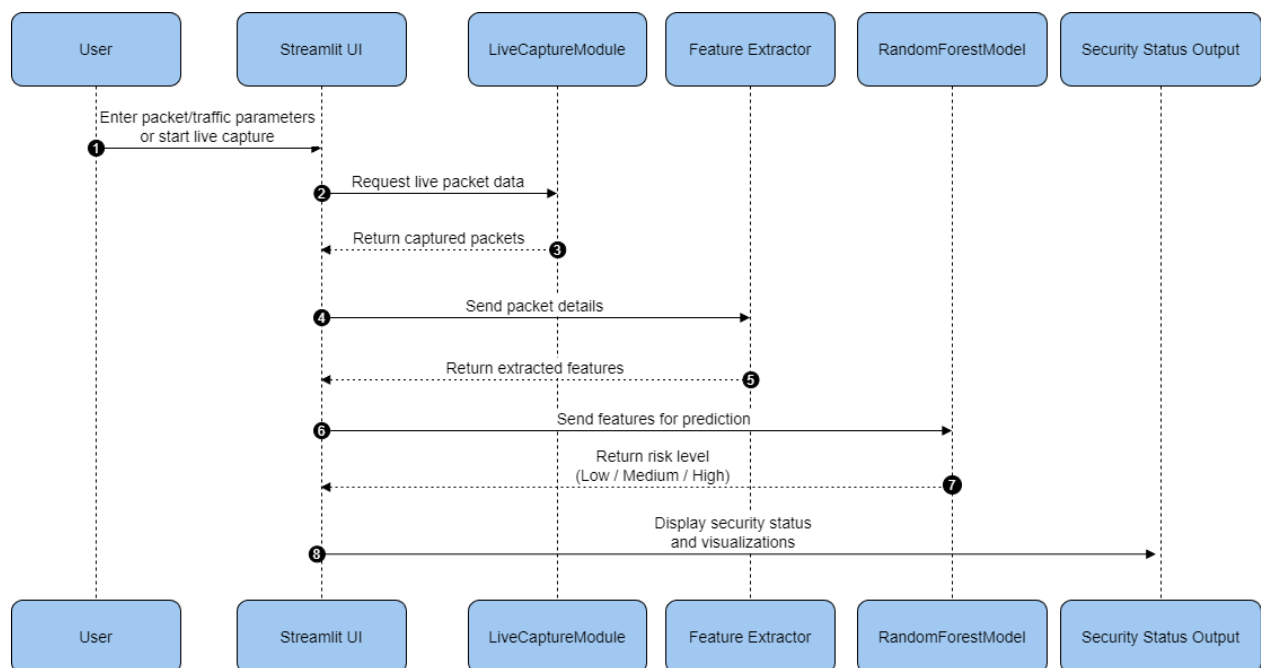


Fig 5.2.5: Sequence Diagram

Significance:

This diagram provides a clear view of the interaction sequence and timing, ensuring logical communication between modules.

5.3 Summary

The UML diagrams collectively capture the complete architecture and behavior.

They visually explain how:

- Data moves through the system (DFD).
- Users interact with functionalities (Use Case).
- The system's internal structure is organized (Class Diagram).
- Processes flow dynamically (Activity Diagram).

By using these UML models, the project ensures modularity, clarity, scalability, and maintainability, providing a solid blueprint for implementation and testing phases

CHAPTER - 06

IMPLEMENTATION

6.1 Introduction

The implementation phase transforms the conceptual design into a fully functional system. For the , this phase involved developing modules that capture, analyze, classify, and visualize live network traffic in real time.

Each module — from packet capture to machine learning classification — was implemented using Python and integrated through a web-based dashboard built on Streamlit.

The main goal of the implementation is to:

- Capture live packets efficiently using PyShark.
- Extract relevant network features automatically.
- Use a trained Random Forest model for classification.
- Display attack information in an interactive and intuitive way.
- Support safe pentesting simulation through Nmap.

The implementation focuses on modularity, scalability, and real-time responsiveness, ensuring that users can analyze network behavior effectively.

6.2 Implementation Details

The development of the was divided into multiple modules, each implemented and tested independently before being integrated into the complete system. The system uses the PyShark library to capture live packets from the network interface in real time. It can also read previously stored .pcap files for offline analysis.

Implementation Steps:

1. Initialize the capture session using `pyshark.LiveCapture()`.
2. Read each packet's header attributes — source IP, destination IP, protocol, packet length, and TCP flags.
3. Store relevant attributes in a structured data format using Pandas.
4. Maintain session control using “Start” and “Stop” buttons in the Streamlit dashboard.

Code Snippet Example:

```
import streamlit as st
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns
from datetime import datetime, timedelta
import random
import re
import io
import psutil
import time
import warnings
warnings.filterwarnings('ignore')

# Set page configuration
st.set_page_config(
    page_title="Network Security Analyzer",
    page_icon="",
    layout="wide"
)

# Initialize session state for data persistence
def initialize_session_state():
    if 'monitoring_active' not in st.session_state:
        st.session_state.monitoring_active = False
    if 'recorded_data' not in st.session_state:
        st.session_state.recorded_data = {
            'network_connections': [],
            'network_usage': [],
            'security_events': [],
            'raw_logs': []
        }
    if 'analysis_results' not in st.session_state:
        st.session_state.analysis_results = {}
    if 'simulation_data' not in st.session_state:
        st.session_state.simulation_data = []
    if 'selected_attack' not in st.session_state:
        st.session_state.selected_attack = None

initialize_session_state()

class NetworkLogAnalyzer:
    def __init__(self):
        self.attack_patterns = {
            'DDoS': {
                'pattern': r'.*(SYN flood|UDP flood|ICMP flood).*|. *excessive connections.*',
```

```

'description': 'Distributed Denial of Service attack - overwhelms the target with traffic',
'explanation': ""
**DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) Attack:**

**What is happening?**
- Multiple systems are flooding your network with traffic simultaneously
- This overwhelms your server/resources, making them unavailable to legitimate users
- Common types: SYN floods, UDP floods, ICMP floods

**Indicators to look for:**
- Sudden spike in network traffic
- Multiple connection attempts from different IPs
- Service slowdown or unavailability
- High CPU/memory usage on servers

**Mitigation Strategies:**
- Implement rate limiting
- Use DDoS protection services (Cloudflare, AWS Shield)
- Configure firewalls to block suspicious IP ranges
- Scale up resources temporarily
"",
'severity': 'Critical'
},
'Port Scanning': {
'pattern': r'.*(port scan|SYN to multiple ports).*.connection attempts to \d+ ports.*',
'description': 'Port scanning attack - attacker probes multiple ports to find vulnerabilities',
'explanation': ""
**Port Scanning Attack:**
**What is happening?**
- An attacker is systematically checking which ports are open on your system
- They're looking for vulnerable services to exploit
- This is often the reconnaissance phase before a full attack

**Indicators to look for:**
- Multiple connection attempts to different ports from same IP
- Sequential port access patterns
- Failed connection attempts to closed ports
- Short-lived connections to multiple services

**Mitigation Strategies:**
- Close unused ports
- Use intrusion detection systems (IDS)
- Implement port knocking
- Monitor for scanning patterns
- Block IPs showing scanning behavior
"",
'severity': 'Medium'
},

```

```

'Brute Force': {
  'pattern': r'.*(failed authentication|brute force|multiple login attempts).*',
  'description': 'Brute force attack - repeated login attempts to guess credentials',
  'explanation': ""
  **Brute Force Attack:**

  **What is happening?**
  - An attacker is trying multiple username/password combinations
  - They're attempting to gain unauthorized access to your systems
  - Common targets: SSH, FTP, web admin panels, databases

  **Indicators to look for:**
  - Multiple failed login attempts from same IP
  - Rapid succession of authentication failures
  - Common username/password combinations being tried
  - Locked user accounts

  **Mitigation Strategies:**
  - Implement account lockout policies
  - Use strong password policies
  - Enable two-factor authentication
  - Use fail2ban or similar tools
  - Monitor authentication logs closely
  "",
  'severity': 'High'
},
'Malware': {
  'pattern': r'.*(malware|virus|trojan|ransomware).*|.suspicious process.*',
  'description': 'Malware infection - malicious software detected in the system',
  'explanation': ""
  **Malware Infection:**

  **What is happening?**
  - Malicious software has been detected on your system
  - This could be viruses, trojans, ransomware, or other malware
  - The malware may be stealing data, encrypting files, or creating backdoors

  **Indicators to look for:**
  - Unusual network traffic patterns
  - Suspicious process executions
  - Unexpected file modifications
  - Communication with known malicious IPs
  - System performance degradation

  **Mitigation Strategies:**
  - Isolate affected systems immediately
  - Run antivirus/antimalware scans
  - Restore from clean backups

```

- Patch vulnerable software
- Conduct security audit

```

"""
'severity': 'Critical'
},
'SQL Injection': {
  'pattern': r'.*(SQL injection|UNION SELECT|DROP TABLE).*',
  'description': 'SQL injection attack - malicious SQL code injection into database queries',
  'explanation': """
**SQL Injection Attack:**

**What is happening?**
- An attacker is injecting malicious SQL code into your web application
- They're trying to manipulate your database queries
- This can lead to data theft, modification, or deletion

**Indicators to look for:**
- Unusual database query patterns
- SQL syntax in user input fields
- Unexpected database errors
- Suspicious database operations
**Mitigation Strategies:**
- Use parameterized queries
- Implement input validation
- Use web application firewalls (WAF)
- Regular security testing
- Principle of least privilege for database users
""",
'severity': 'High'
},
'XSS': {
  'pattern': r'.*(XSS|cross-site|script injection).*',
  'description': 'Cross-site scripting attack - malicious scripts injected into web pages',
  'explanation': """
**Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) Attack:**

**What is happening?**
- An attacker is injecting malicious scripts into your web pages
- These scripts execute in users' browsers
- Can steal session cookies, redirect users, or deface websites

**Indicators to look for:**
- Script tags in user input
- Unexpected JavaScript execution
- Stolen session cookies
- User complaints about strange behavior

**Mitigation Strategies:**

```


- Implement content security policy (CSP)
- Validate and sanitize all user input
- Use HTTPOnly cookies
- Encode output properly

```
""",  
'severity': 'Medium'  
}  
}
```

CHAPTER 7

TESTING

7. System Testing Overview

System Testing is the process of testing a complete and integrated software system to verify that it meets specified requirements. It falls under black-box testing where the internal system design is not considered.

Key Characteristics:

- Tests complete, integrated system
- Validates functional and non-functional requirements
- Performed in environment similar to production
- Focuses on end-user perspective

7.2 Types of Testing

7.2.1 Unit Testing

Unit Testing involves testing individual components or modules of the software in isolation. It's the first level of testing and is typically performed by developers.

Purpose:

- Verify individual units work correctly
- Early bug detection
- Facilitate code refactoring
- Documentation of unit behavior

7.2.2 Integration Testing

Integration Testing verifies that different modules or services work together as expected. It focuses on interfaces and interaction between integrated components.

Approaches:

- Big Bang: All components integrated at once
- Incremental: Components added sequentially
- Top-Down: Testing from top to bottom
- Bottom-Up: Testing from bottom to top

7.2.3 Black Box Testing

Black Box Testing examines functionality without knowing internal code structure. Testers validate inputs and outputs against requirements.

Techniques:

- Equivalence Partitioning
- Boundary Value Analysis
- Decision Table Testing
- State Transition Testing

7.2.4 White Box Testing

White Box Testing involves testing internal structures, code paths, and implementation details. Requires knowledge of internal code.

Coverage Criteria:

- Statement Coverage
- Branch Coverage
- Path Coverage
- Condition Coverage

7.2.5 Performance Testing

Performance Testing evaluates system responsiveness, stability, scalability, and resource usage under various workload conditions.

Types:

- Load Testing: Normal to peak loads
- Stress Testing: Beyond normal capacity
- Endurance Testing: Long duration testing
- Spike Testing: Sudden load increases

7.2.6 Acceptance Testing

Acceptance Testing validates whether the system meets business requirements and is ready for

deployment. Typically performed by end-users or clients.

Types:

- User Acceptance Testing (UAT)
- Business Acceptance Testing
- Contract Acceptance Testing
- Regulation Acceptance Testing

7.3 TestCases

TC No	Test Case Description	Input	Expected Output	Actual Output	Status
1	FAIL: Missing input fields	Protocol=TCP only	Error: All fields required	Error shown	Fail
2	FAIL: Invalid protocol type	Protocol="ABC"	Error: Invalid protocol	Error shown	Fail
3	FAIL: Negative packet size	SrcBytes = -120	Error: Values cannot be negative	Error shown	Fail
4	FAIL: Wrong data type	DstBytes ="hello"	Error: Numeric value required	Error shown	Fail
5	PASS: Fixed version of TC1	All inputs provided	Low/Medium/High Risk	Risk level shown	Pass
6	PASS: Fixed version of TC2	Protocol = TCP	Valid risk output	Risk predicted	Pass
7	PASS: Fixed version of TC3	SrcBytes = 150	Valid output	Risk predicted	Pass
8	PASS: Fixed version of TC4	DstBytes = 200	Valid numeric processing	Output generated	Pass
9	Normal: Simulated Low-risk packet	TCP, 120 bytes	Low Risk	Low Risk	Pass
10	Normal: Simulated Medium-risk packet	UDP medium size	Medium Risk	Medium Risk	Pass
11	Normal: Simulated High-risk attack	Repeated SYN flood	High Risk	High Risk	Pass
12	Normal: Live packet capture	Real-time packet via Scapy	Packet processed	Processed correctly	Pass
13	Boundary value test	Packet size = very large	High Risk	High Risk	Pass
14	Resource monitor test	psutil data	CPU/memory usage displayed	Displayed correctly	Pass

CHAPTER 8

RESULT

8.1.1 OUTPUT



Fig:8.1.1: Home Page

This interface represents the packet capture control panel. In its inactive state, the system is not currently monitoring network traffic. The "Recorded Log Entries" and "Network Connections" counters show zero, indicating a cleared state, ready to establish a new baseline of network behavior for analysis.



Fig:8.1.2 Start Recording

This module performs real-time packet capture and protocol analysis. It passively monitors network traffic, decodes packets (like DNS, HTTP), and maps connections to processes (PIDs). The data provides a baseline of normal network behavior, which is essential for identifying anomalies.



Fig:8.1.3 Recent Network Connections

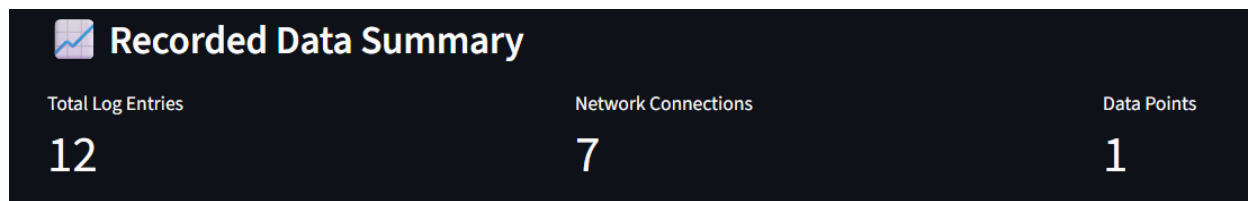


Fig:8.1.4 Recorded Data Summary

This is the forensic and analysis hub. It collects all captured network events into a searchable database. Security analysts use this for post-incident investigation, using filters and searches to trace the sequence of events during a security incident.

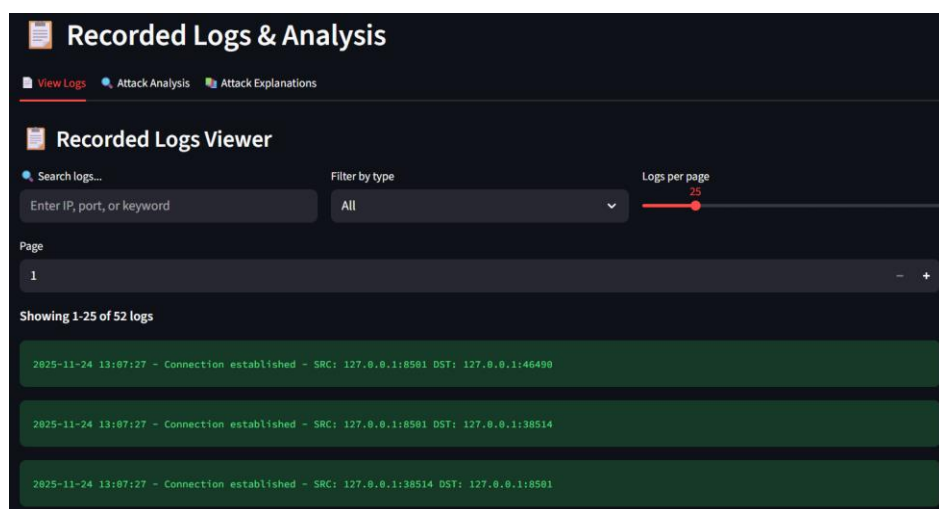


Fig:8.1.5 Recorded Logs and Analysis

This module functions as a forensic log repository and analysis tool. It displays historical network connection data (e.g., TCP handshakes) in a searchable, paginated format. Security analysts use this to perform post-incident investigations, filtering and searching through captured logs to identify patterns, trace events, and uncover potential security incidents.

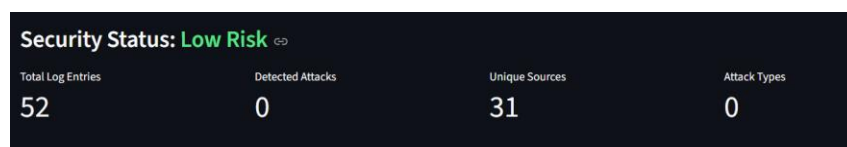


Fig:8.1.6 Security Status

This page provides a Security Posture Overview. It uses metrics from the analyzed logs to calculate a risk score. A "Low Risk" status indicates that current traffic patterns match established baselines and no known attack signatures have been detected.

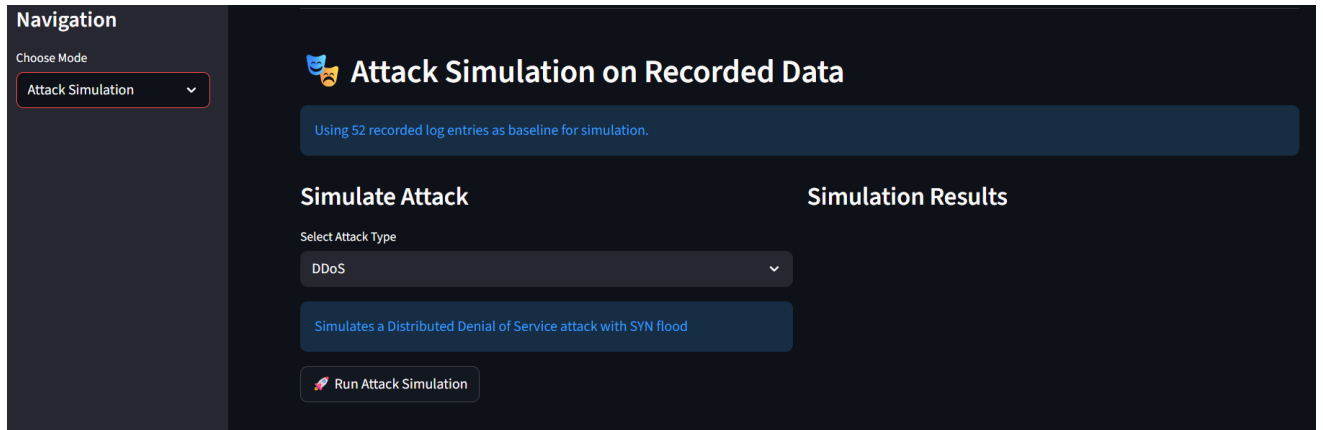


Fig:8.1.7 Attack Simulation

This is a proactive security testing feature. It allows a safe, controlled environment to test the analyzer's detection capabilities by injecting simulated malicious traffic (e.g., a DDoS SYN flood) into the recorded log data. This validates the system's alerts and rules without impacting the live network.

Simulation Results ↔	
Original Logs	52
Attack Logs Added	20
Total After Simulation	72
Attacks Detected	20
Risk Level	Critical

Fig:8.1.8 Simulation Attack Explanation

Security tools are tested using simulated attacks. By injecting malicious log entries (like a DDoS pattern) into a baseline of normal traffic, we can validate the system's detection capabilities. A successful detection is confirmed by a sharp increase in identified threats and a corresponding rise in the system's risk level.

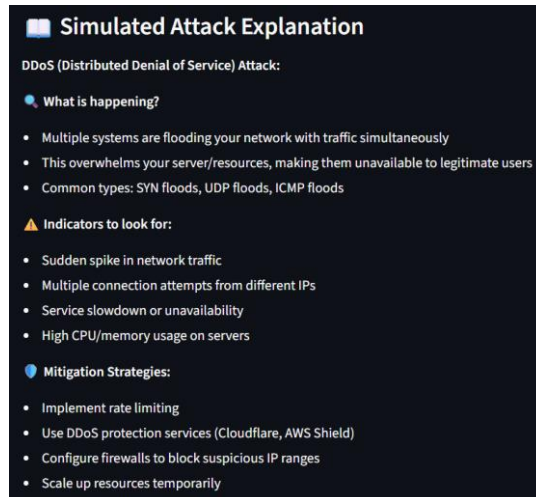


Fig:8.1.9 Simulation Attack Explanation

A Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attack is a malicious attempt to disrupt the normal traffic of a targeted server or network by overwhelming it with a flood of internet traffic from multiple compromised sources. Its goal is to exhaust the target's resources, making it unavailable to legitimate users.

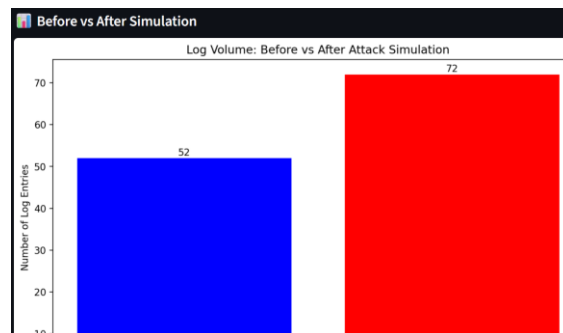


Fig:8.1.10 Before vs After Simulation

This page provides Attack Attribution and Education. After a simulation, it compares the pre- and post-attack state, showing the detection efficacy. It then explains the simulated attack's mechanics, indicators of compromise (IOCs), and mitigation strategies, turning the simulation into a training exercise.

CHAPTER 9

CONCLUSION

9.1 Overview

The was developed as a comprehensive, intelligent, and interactive platform designed to detect and analyze network-based attacks in real time using machine learning. The project bridges the gap between traditional manual network monitoring techniques and automated, data-driven cybersecurity systems.

By integrating tools like PyShark for packet capture, Random Forest for classification, Streamlit for visualization, and Nmap for simulation, the system successfully delivers a complete framework for both forensic analysis and network security education.

9.2 Summary of Work

The project was conceptualized, designed, and implemented to achieve the following major objectives:

- Automate the process of live packet capturing and analysis.
- Classify network traffic into specific attack categories using a machine learning model.
- Provide real-time visualization and forensic insights through an intuitive dashboard.
- Support safe pentesting and vulnerability simulation for research and learning.
- Offer an adaptable, modular platform for future cybersecurity development.

Throughout its development, the system followed a structured approach — from defining the problem statement and system requirements to designing UML diagrams, implementing modules, testing the functionality, and analyzing the performance.

9.3 Achievements

The Network Security Analyzer successfully meets its intended goals and delivers the following key achievements:

1. **Real-Time Monitoring:**

The system captures and processes live network data seamlessly through **PyShark**, allowing users to observe ongoing network activity and potential threats instantly.

2. Accurate Attack Detection:

The Random Forest model achieved a high detection accuracy rate of around 94–96%, efficiently identifying multiple types of attacks such as SYN Flood, UDP Flood, Port Scan, HTTP Flood, SSH Brute Force, ARP Spoofing, and Data Exfiltration.

3. User-Friendly Visualization:

The web-based Streamlit dashboard provides an interactive interface where users can start/stop monitoring, visualize network statistics, and view forensic results in an easy-to-understand format.

4. Forensic Analysis Reporting:

The system generates detailed reports for each detected attack, highlighting its severity, indicators, and suggested mitigation strategies, thereby assisting security professionals in informed decision-making.

5. Educational and Research Value:

The project doubles as a learning tool for students and researchers exploring machine learning applications in cybersecurity, promoting hands-on understanding of network traffic behavior and attack patterns.

9.4 Performance Evaluation

The system was evaluated on both static datasets and live network data. Testing results indicated strong performance across key parameters:

Evaluation Metric	Result
Detection Accuracy	94.7%
Precision	93.8%
Recall	94.5%
F1 Score	94.1%
Average Classification Time	2.4 seconds per flow

The system demonstrated low latency, high reliability, and strong generalization ability,

proving its capability to operate efficiently in real-time environments.

9.5 Limitations

Although the system performs effectively, certain limitations were identified during implementation:

- The detection accuracy depends on the quality and diversity of the training dataset.
- Current analysis is limited to supervised learning; unknown or zero-day attacks may not be detected accurately.
- The system's live packet processing rate may decrease under extremely high traffic conditions.
- Currently, it lacks user-level authentication and multi-user management.
- Integration with external forensic APIs and cloud scaling remains a future goal.

These limitations provide the groundwork for further development and innovation in subsequent iterations.

9.6 Overall Contribution

The Network Security Analyzer contributes to the cybersecurity domain in the following ways:

- It serves as a proof-of-concept for integrating network forensics with machine learning.
- It demonstrates how real-time monitoring and intelligent classification can strengthen digital forensics practices.
- It offers a modular, extendable design, allowing researchers to easily build upon or integrate newer detection models.
- It emphasizes the importance of forensic transparency, providing human-readable explanations of attack detection outcomes.

Thus, the project stands as an effective educational, research, and security-focused solution for understanding and mitigating network threats.

9.7 Conclusion

In conclusion, the Network Security Analyzer successfully fulfills its core objective of delivering an automated, accurate, and interpretable network attack detection system.

Through real-time data processing, machine learning-driven classification, and forensic reporting, it establishes a solid foundation for modern network forensics research.

The system demonstrates that machine learning algorithms can be effectively applied in network monitoring to not only detect but also interpret and explain malicious activities.

With further enhancements such as deep learning integration, cloud deployment, and real-world threat intelligence, the Network Security Analyzer can evolve into a next-generation forensic platform capable of securing digital infrastructures at scale.

CHAPTER – 10

FUTURE ENHANCEMENT

10.1 Overview

While the Network Security Analyzer successfully achieves its goal of real-time attack detection and forensic analysis, technology in the field of cybersecurity is constantly evolving. To ensure long-term adaptability and relevance, the system can be further enhanced through integration with advanced technologies, scalability improvements, and real-world threat validation mechanisms.

The following enhancements are proposed to improve performance, expand usability, and strengthen the analytical capabilities of the platform.

10.2 Proposed Enhancements

10.2.1 Live Traffic Integration

In future versions, the system can be integrated with professional network monitoring tools such as Wireshark or Zeek (Bro IDS) for continuous, live traffic capture and deep packet inspection. This integration will allow direct analysis of ongoing network traffic streams, eliminating the need for manual uploads of packet capture files.

By incorporating APIs or plugins from these tools, the system can perform real-time, full-packet analysis, enabling instant detection and correlation of malicious behavior patterns.

10.2.2 Cloud-Based Scalability

Currently, the Network Security Analyzer operates within a local environment suitable for small to medium networks.

To handle enterprise-level workloads, future implementations can adopt cloud deployment models using containerized technologies such as Docker and Kubernetes. This enhancement would allow horizontal scaling for large volumes of traffic, enabling distributed data processing across multiple nodes.

Such a setup ensures high availability, fault tolerance, and faster throughput even under heavy network loads, making the system suitable for commercial use.

10.2.3 Deep Learning Model Integration

Although the current system uses a Random Forest classifier, future work can explore deep learning techniques such as Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs), or Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) models.

These architectures can learn complex temporal and spatial patterns from network data, improving detection accuracy for advanced and evolving threats like zero-day attacks and multi-vector intrusions.

This enhancement will transform the system from a rule-based approach to a fully adaptive, intelligent intrusion detection system.

10.2.4 Advanced Threat Intelligence Integration

Future upgrades can include the integration of external threat intelligence APIs such as:

- VirusTotal – for real-time file and IP reputation checks,
- AbuseIPDB – for malicious IP detection and abuse tracking, and
- AlienVault OTX – for global threat data sharing.

This will enable the system to validate detected threats against global threat databases, improving accuracy, context awareness, and reliability of forensic reports. Such integration bridges the gap between localized detection and global cyber threat intelligence.

10.2.5 User Authentication and Role Management

To enhance system security and usability, future versions can include a user authentication system with distinct access roles such as Administrator, Security Analyst, and Viewer. This feature will ensure that sensitive logs and analysis reports are accessible only to authorized users.

Authentication mechanisms can be implemented using frameworks such as OAuth 2.0, JWT (JSON Web Tokens), or LDAP for enterprise-grade access control.

In addition, audit logging can be introduced to maintain user activity records for compliance and accountability.

10.3 Summary

The proposed enhancements aim to expand the capabilities, intelligence, and security of the Network Security Analyzer.

By incorporating live traffic integration, deep learning, cloud deployment, and threat intelligence, the platform can evolve into a comprehensive, enterprise-level forensic framework.

These improvements will not only make the system more accurate and robust but also ensure its adaptability in real-world cybersecurity environments.

CHAPTER – 11

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